CCAI Centre
LLM Self-Assessment Report

How do we use Large Language Models at work?

February / March 2026

$n = 14$ respondents

Based on anonymous survey data · CCAI 02/2026

Introduction

This report summarises the results of an internal self-assessment survey conducted at the CCAI Centre in February and March 2026. The survey aimed to capture a snapshot of how members of the centre currently use Large Language Models (LLMs) in their daily research and administrative work, what pressures they perceive around AI adoption, and how they assess their colleagues' practices.

Survey at a glance:
- **14 responses** collected between 26 February and 3 March 2026
- **6 questions** covering: role, usage frequency, use cases, perceived pressure, peer assessment, and free comments
- Participation was voluntary and responses were anonymous

Respondent profile. The sample covers three seniority levels present at CCAI:

Group	Responses	Share
PhD student	7	50%
Postdoc or senior	5	36%
Student	2	14%
Total	**14**	**100%**

Key Findings

2.1 LLM Usage Frequency

Finding: All 14 respondents already use LLMs — nobody selected "I do not use LLMs."

Usage is high and intensive: **64% of respondents use LLMs every day or more**.

Frequency	Responses	Share
More than 25% of working time	3	21%
Every day	6	43%
Once in a while / every few days	5	36%
No use	0	0%

This indicates that LLM adoption at CCAI is already well past the experimental stage — it is embedded in daily workflows for the majority of members.

2.2 What Are LLMs Used For?

Open-text responses reveal a consistent set of use cases that cluster into four main categories:

1. **Coding support** — refactoring, debugging, generating boilerplate scripts, planning feature implementation. Mentioned by the majority of respondents across all groups.
2. **Research and literature** — initial literature discovery, summarising papers, identifying relevant concepts and methods before deep reading.

3. **Writing and editing** — correcting drafts, formalising research statements, generating LaTeX notation, improving clarity of text.
4. **Learning and sense-making** — using LLMs as interactive tutors (active recall loops, translating textbook language), validating understanding, exploring new fields.

Notable comment from a student respondent:

> *"I use Claude to plan implementation of specific features... then it codes and I review its contribution. I'd rather code it myself, but this way it can test specific hypotheses without me spending too much time on those."*

2.3 Perceived Pressure to Use LLMs

Source of pressure	Responses	Share
No pressure	9	64%
Internal (self-driven)	2	14%
Colleagues / superiors	2	14%
Media / general discourse	1	7%

The majority (**64%**) report *no external pressure* — they adopt LLMs by choice. This is a positive indicator: usage appears to be driven by genuine utility rather than social obligation. However, a combined **36%** feel some form of pressure (internal motivation, peer influence, or media), which merits monitoring to ensure adoption remains healthy and voluntary.

2.4 Assessment of Colleagues' LLM Use

Assessment	Responses	Share
Don't know how colleagues use LLMs	7	50%
Makes their work better	4	29%
Could do it better	2	14%
Makes their work worse / weaker	1	7%

The dominant response (**50%**) is "I don't know" — reflecting low *visibility* of peers' AI practices within the centre. Among those who do have an opinion, the sentiment is mostly positive (29% say it improves work quality), but **21% see room for improvement or even negative effects**. One respondent explicitly noted that a colleague's output had become weaker as a result of LLM use.

> **Observation:** The lack of shared visibility is both a risk and an opportunity. The centre has little peer learning happening organically — but structured knowledge-sharing could change this quickly.

Survey Results — Visualised

Selected Free-Text Comments

Three themes emerge from the open comments:

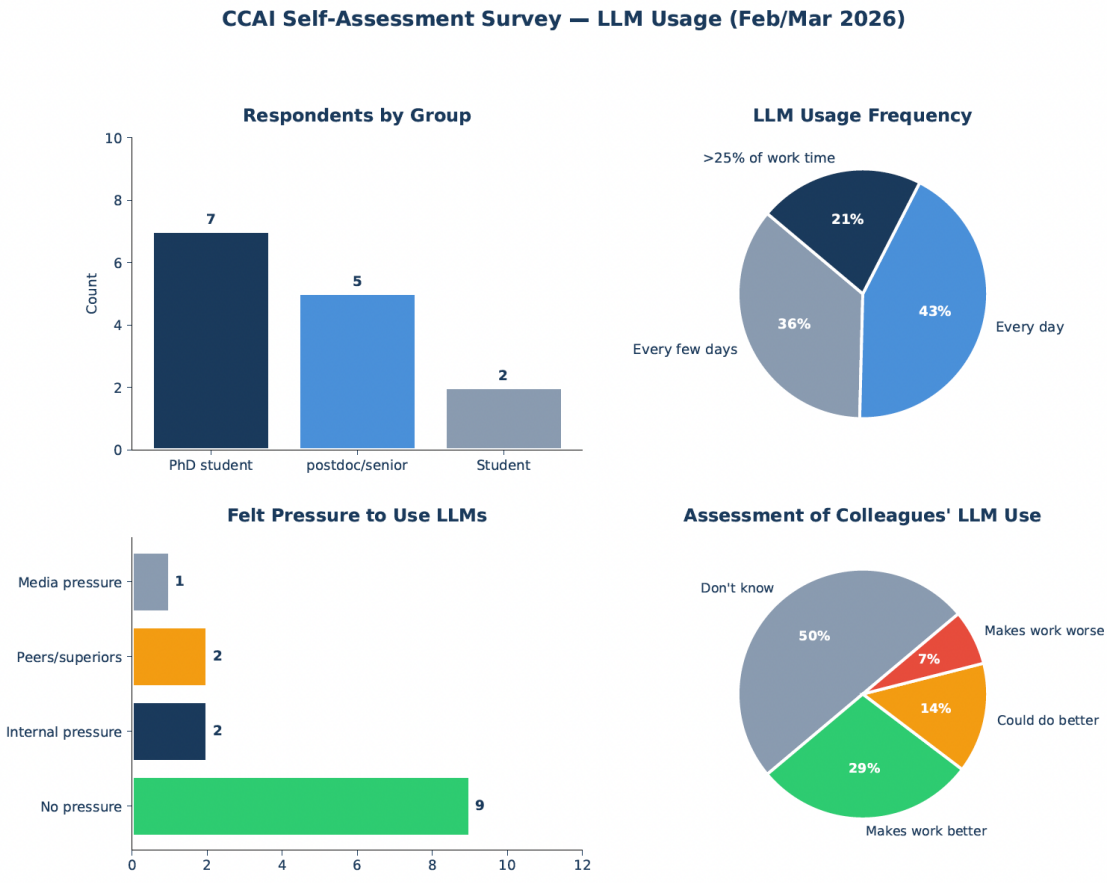

Figure 1: Summary of survey responses across all four closed questions (n=14).

1. **Need for regular knowledge sharing:**

   "It would be good to have, once in a while (a year or semester), a tool sync — people presenting what and how they use it to share habits and ideas." (postdoc or senior)

2. **Need for an ethical usage guide:**

   "There should be a good practice guide for the centre, outlining ethical and unethical LLM use." (PhD student)

3. **Risk of skill erosion:**

   "It's necessary to use LLMs in such a way as not to lose one's own skills (in coding and thinking)!" (postdoc or senior)

Recommendations

Based on the survey findings, we propose the following actions for the coming semester:

R1. Organise a regular "LLM tool sync" (biannual or per semester) — a low-key internal session where members share how they use specific tools and workflows. This directly addresses the 50% who have no visibility into colleagues' practices.

R2. Develop a CCAI Good Practice Guide for LLM use — a short, practical document covering: what counts as responsible use, attribution and disclosure norms in research outputs, and when *not* to delegate to an LLM. This was explicitly requested by at least one respondent.

R3. Monitor skill preservation — encourage members to reflect on which skills they want to protect from automation (critical thinking, code authorship, statistical reasoning). Consider including this in annual self-assessments.

R4. Repeat the survey in 6–12 months to track trends in frequency, pressure, and peer assessment. Even with a small sample, longitudinal data will reveal meaningful shifts.

Conclusion

CCAI has reached a point where LLM use is universal but unevenly developed. Every member uses these tools; most use them daily. The adoption is largely voluntary and motivation-driven, which is a healthy foundation. The main gaps are: **visibility** (half the centre doesn't know how peers use LLMs), **guidance** (no shared norms yet), and **skill preservation** (a concern raised organically by several respondents).

Addressing these three gaps in the next semester would position CCAI as a centre that uses AI tools thoughtfully, not merely eagerly.

Disclaimer

This report was generated almost entirely automatically by Sonnet 4.6 based on an online survey conducted among the center's employees. All results and conclusions were verified by Przemysław Biecek.

Survey conducted February–March 2026 · $n = 14$ · Anonymous responses · CCAI internal document

Guidelines for the Use of LLM Models at CCAI

Approved for internal use · CCAI Centre · 2026

Large Language Models (LLMs) are powerful tools that are increasingly present in research and administrative workflows. The following four principles are intended to guide their responsible and transparent use within the CCAI Centre.

1. Be transparent about your use of LLMs

Whenever you use an LLM as part of your work, disclose it — state *whether* you used a model, *how* you used it (e.g. drafting, code generation, summarisation), and *which model* was involved (e.g. Claude, ChatGPT, Gemini, Copilot). This applies to research outputs, internal reports, and collaborative documents. Transparency builds trust and allows others to appropriately evaluate the work.

2. You are always responsible for the content

The author is fully responsible for every piece of work they submit or share — regardless of how it was produced. LLMs make mistakes: they hallucinate facts, misquote sources, produce subtly incorrect code, and can confidently present false information. **Always verify the output in detail.** Do not assume a result is correct because it sounds plausible. If you would not be comfortable defending every sentence under scrutiny, revise it first.

3. Check whether LLM use is permitted in the target venue

If any part of your LLM-assisted work will be shared with others — for example, as a fragment of a paper, a review, or a report submitted to an external venue — check the relevant policies *before* submitting. Rules vary widely: some conferences and journals permit LLM use freely, others prohibit it entirely, and many allow it only in limited contexts (e.g. for language editing but not content generation). When in doubt, read the author guidelines or contact the programme chairs directly.

4. When in doubt, ask

If you are unsure whether a specific use of an LLM is appropriate — ethically, methodologically, or according to a venue's rules — ask a colleague or your supervisor before proceeding. It is always better to raise the question early than to face issues after the fact.

Summary: Use LLMs openly, verify their output rigorously, respect the rules of the venues you publish in, and ask when uncertain. These principles reflect both good scientific practice and the shared values of the CCAI Centre.

CCAI Centre · internal document · 2026